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Tharifith

Riffian Language Course

LESSON 2

Personal Pronouns

A Comprehensive Guide for Beginners Created by LEARN THARIFITH

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1. Introduction to Personal Pronouns

Personal pronouns are among the most fundamental building blocks of any language, serving as the words we use to refer to ourselves and others without using names. In Tharifith, personal pronouns play a crucial role in sentence construction, as they indicate who is performing an action, who is receiving an action, or who possesses something. Understanding the pronoun system is essential for constructing meaningful sentences and engaging in natural conversation. The Riffian pronoun system is particularly interesting because it distinguishes not only between singular and plural, but also between masculine and feminine in the second and third person singular, reflecting the grammatical gender system that pervades the entire language.

What makes Tharifith pronouns particularly fascinating is their dual function: they can appear as independent words standing alone in sentences, and they can also be attached to verbs as affixes to indicate the subject or object of an action. This dual nature creates a rich system where pronouns can be emphasized by appearing independently or can be subtly integrated into verb forms for more fluid expression. As you learn these pronouns, you will notice patterns that connect to other aspects of the language, including the gender distinctions you have already learned in numbers and the prefix patterns you have seen in nouns. Mastering personal pronouns will unlock your ability to construct a wide variety of sentences and express complex relationships between people and actions.

2. Subject Pronouns

Subject pronouns in Tharifith indicate who is performing the action of a verb. These pronouns correspond to the English pronouns "I," "you," "he," "she," "we," and "they." In Tharifith, subject pronouns can appear either as independent words before the verb or as prefixes attached to the verb, depending on the emphasis and the specific grammatical construction being used. The independent forms are particularly important to learn first, as they provide clear, emphatic identification of the subject and are essential for beginning learners to form basic sentences.

2.1 Singular Subject Pronouns

The singular subject pronouns in Tharifith are "nech" (I), "chek" (you, masculine), "chem" (you, feminine), "netta" (he), and "nettath" (she). Each of these pronouns carries important grammatical and social information. The distinction between masculine and feminine in the second person (you) is particularly important, as using the correct form shows respect for the person you are addressing and demonstrates your understanding of the gender system. The

third person pronouns "netta" and "nettath" parallel the English "he" and "she," maintaining the masculine-feminine distinction that is consistent throughout Tharifith grammar.

English	Tharifith	Tifinagh	Notes
I	**nech**	ⵏⴻⵛ	First person singular
you (masc.)	**chek**	ⵛⴻⴽ	Second person masculine
you (fem.)	**chem**	ⵛⴻⵎ	Second person feminine
he	**netta**	ⵏⴻⵜⵜⴰ	Third person masculine
she	**nettath**	ⵏⴻⵜⵜⴰⵜ	Third person feminine

Table 1: Singular Subject Pronouns

2.2 Plural Subject Pronouns

The plural subject pronouns in Tharifith are "nechnin" (we), "kenniw" (you, masculine plural), "kennint" (you, feminine plural), "nethnin" (they, masculine), and "nethnint" (they, feminine). Notice that the plural forms extend the gender distinctions of the singular forms: just as there is a distinction between "chek" (you, masculine singular) and "chem" (you, feminine singular), there is also a distinction between "kenniw" and "kennint" in the plural. Similarly, the third person plural maintains the masculine-feminine distinction with "nethnin" and "nethnint." This systematic consistency across the pronoun system reflects the importance of gender in Tharifith grammar.

English	Tharifith	Tifinagh	Notes
we	**nechnin**	ⵏⴻⵛⵏⵉⵏ	First person plural
you (masc. pl.)	**kenniw**	ⴽⴻⵏⵏⵉⵡ	Second person masculine
you (fem. pl.)	**kennint**	ⴽⴻⵏⵏⵉⵏⵜ	Second person feminine
they (masc.)	**nethnin**	ⵏⴻⵜⵏⵉⵏ	Third person masculine
they (fem.)	**nethnint**	ⵏⴻⵜⵏⵉⵏⵜ	Third person feminine

Table 2: Plural Subject Pronouns

3. Object Pronouns

Object pronouns in Tharifith are used to indicate the recipient or target of an action. These pronouns correspond to English pronouns such as "me," "you," "him," "her," "us," and "them."

Object pronouns in Tharifith can appear as independent words or, more commonly, as suffixes attached to verbs. Understanding object pronouns is essential for constructing sentences where someone or something receives the action of a verb, such as "I see him" or "She calls us." The object pronoun system in Tharifith shows some differences from the subject pronouns, particularly in the way they attach to verbs and the specific forms they take.

3.1 Direct Object Pronouns

Direct object pronouns indicate who or what directly receives the action of a verb. In Tharifith, these pronouns are typically suffixed to the verb.

The forms are:

- "-i" or "-iyi" (me),
- "-chek" (you, masculine),
- "-chem" (you, feminine),
- "-th" (him/it, masculine),
- "-t" (her/it, feminine),
- "-nɣ" (us),
- "-kom" (you, plural masculine),
- "-kent" (you, plural feminine),
- "-ten" (them, masculine), and "-tent" (them, feminine).

These suffixes attach directly to the verb, creating a single integrated word that carries both the action and the object of the action.

English	Suffix	Tifinagh	Example
me	**-i / -yi**	ⵅ / ⵢⵅ	iẓra-i / izra-yi (he saw me)
you (masc.)	**-chek**	ⵛⴽ	iẓra-chek (he saw you)
you (fem.)	**-chem**	ⵛⵎ	iẓra-chem (he saw you)
him/it (masc.)	**-th**	ⵜ	iẓra-th (he saw him)
her/it (fem.)	**-t**	ⵜ	iẓra-t (he saw her)

English	Suffix	Tifinagh	Example
us	**-nɣ**	ⵏⵖ	iẓra-nɣ (he saw us)
them (masc.)	**-then**	ⵜⵀⵏ	iẓra-then (he saw them)
them (fem.)	**-thent**	ⵜⵀⵏⵜ	iẓra-thent (he saw them)

Table 3: Direct Object Pronoun Suffixes

4. Possessive Pronouns and Suffixes

Possessive pronouns indicate ownership or association, answering the question "whose?" In Tharifith, possession is typically expressed through suffixes attached to nouns rather than separate possessive pronouns. This system is fundamentally different from English, where possession is expressed through independent words like "my," "your," "his," "her," etc. The Tharifith possessive suffixes attach directly to the noun they modify, creating a single integrated word that expresses both the object and its possessor. Understanding this system is crucial for expressing relationships, family connections, and ownership in natural Tharifith speech.

4.1 Possessive Suffixes

The possessive suffixes in Tharifith are attached to nouns to indicate the possessor. The basic forms are: "-inu" (my), "-inek" (your, masculine singular), "-inem" (your, feminine singular), "-ines" (his/her/its), "-nneɣ" (our), "-nkum" (your, masculine plural), "-nkent" (your, feminine plural), "-nsen" (their, masculine), and "-nsent" (their, feminine). These suffixes attach to the noun after any plural or gender markers, creating a single word that expresses both the possessed object and the possessor. For example, "akham / Axxam" (room) becomes "akham-inu" (my room), "akham-inek" (your room, to a man), and "akham-inem" (your room, to a woman).

English	Suffix	Tifinagh	Example
my	**-inu**	ⵉⵏⵓ	akham-inu (my room)
your (masc. sg.)	**-inek**	ⵉⵏⴽ	akham-inek (your room)
your (fem. sg.)	**-inem**	ⵉⵏⵎ	akham-inem (your room)
his/her/its	**-ines**	ⵉⵏⵙ	akham-ines (his/her room)
our	**-nneɣ**	ⵏⵏⵖ	akham-nneɣ (our room)
your (masc. pl.)	**-nkum**	ⵏⴽⵓⵎ	akham-nkum (your room)
your (fem. pl.)	**-nkent**	ⵏⴽⵏⵜ	Akham-nkent (your room)

English	Suffix	Tifinagh	Example
their (masc.)	**-nsen**	ⵏⵙⵏ	akham-nsen (their room)
their (fem.)	**-nsent**	ⵏⵙⵏⵜ	akham-nsent (their room)

Table 4: Possessive Suffixes

5. Using Pronouns in Sentences

Now that you have learned the various types of pronouns in Tharifith, it is important to understand how they function in actual sentences. Pronouns in Tharifith can appear in different positions depending on whether they are subjects, objects, or possessors. The following examples demonstrate how pronouns are used in context, showing both independent pronouns and affixed forms. Understanding these patterns will help you construct natural-sounding sentences and comprehend the pronoun usage you will encounter in native Tharifith speech and writing.

5.1 Subject Pronouns in Sentences

When subject pronouns appear as independent words, they typically precede the verb and serve to emphasize or clarify the subject. For example, "Nech tettegh" means "I am eating," where "nech" explicitly identifies "I am" as the subject. In questions or when contrasting different subjects, the independent pronoun becomes more necessary. For instance, "chek tettedh, nech ur-tettegh-chi" means "You are eating, I am not eating," where the contrast between "chek" and "nech" is essential to the meaning.

Tharifith	English	Notes
Nech guregh	I am walking	Subject pronoun emphasized
Netta iẓra-th	He saw him	Subject + object suffix
Nechnin neggur	We are walking	Plural subject pronoun
Kenint theggurent	You (fem.) are walking	Feminine subject pronoun

Table 6: Subject Pronouns in Sentences

6. Practice Exercises

6.1 Subject Pronoun Translation

Translate the following English pronouns into Tharifith:

1. I _____
2. you (to a woman) _____
3. he _____
4. we _____
5. they (feminine) _____

6.2 Object Pronoun Suffixes

Write the correct object pronoun suffix for each English pronoun:

1. me → _____
2. you (masculine) → _____
3. her → _____
4. us → _____
5. them (masculine) → _____

6.3 Possessive Suffixes

Add the correct possessive suffix to "thadarth" (house) for each possessor:

1. my house: thadarth_____
2. your house (to a man): thadarth_____
3. his/her house: thadarth _____
4. our house: thadarth _____
5. their house (feminine): thadarth _____

6.4 Sentence Construction

Translate the following sentences into Tharifith using the pronouns you have learned:

1. I saw him. ____zrigh-_____
2. She saw me. ___thezra-_____
3. This is my house. ____thadarth_____
4. They (fem.) saw us. ____zrint-a_____

5. We saw them (masc.). ____nezra-_____

7. Answer Key

7.1 Subject Pronoun Translation

1. nech
2. chem
3. netta
4. nechnin
5. nethnint

7.2 Object Pronoun Suffixes

1. -i / -iyi
2. -chek
3. -t
4. -nɣ
5. -thent

7.3 Possessive Suffixes

1. thadarth-inu
2. thadarth-inek
3. thadarth-ines
4. thadarth-nneɣ
5. thadarth-nsent

7.4 Sentence Construction

1. Nech ẓigh-th (I saw him)
2. Nettath theẓra-i / theẓra-yi (She saw me)
3. Tha thadarth ino (This is my house)
4. Nethnint ẓrinta-nɣ (They [fem.] saw us)
5. Nechnin n-ẓra-ten (We saw them [masc.])

8. Lesson Summary

In this second lesson, you have acquired a comprehensive understanding of the personal pronoun system in Tharifith. You have learned the subject pronouns for all persons, including the important gender distinctions in the second and third persons. You have mastered the object pronoun suffixes that attach to verbs to indicate the recipient of actions, and you have learned the possessive suffixes that attach to nouns to express ownership and relationships.

The pronoun system you have learned in this lesson is fundamental to all communication in Tharifith. These forms will appear in virtually every conversation you have and every text you read. As you continue through this course, you will see how these pronouns integrate with verb conjugations and other grammatical structures. We recommend practicing these pronouns regularly by constructing simple sentences and by identifying pronouns in the Tharifith texts you encounter. In the next lesson, we will explore vocabulary related to family and relationships, which will give you the opportunity to use your new pronoun knowledge in meaningful contexts about personal connections and kinship.